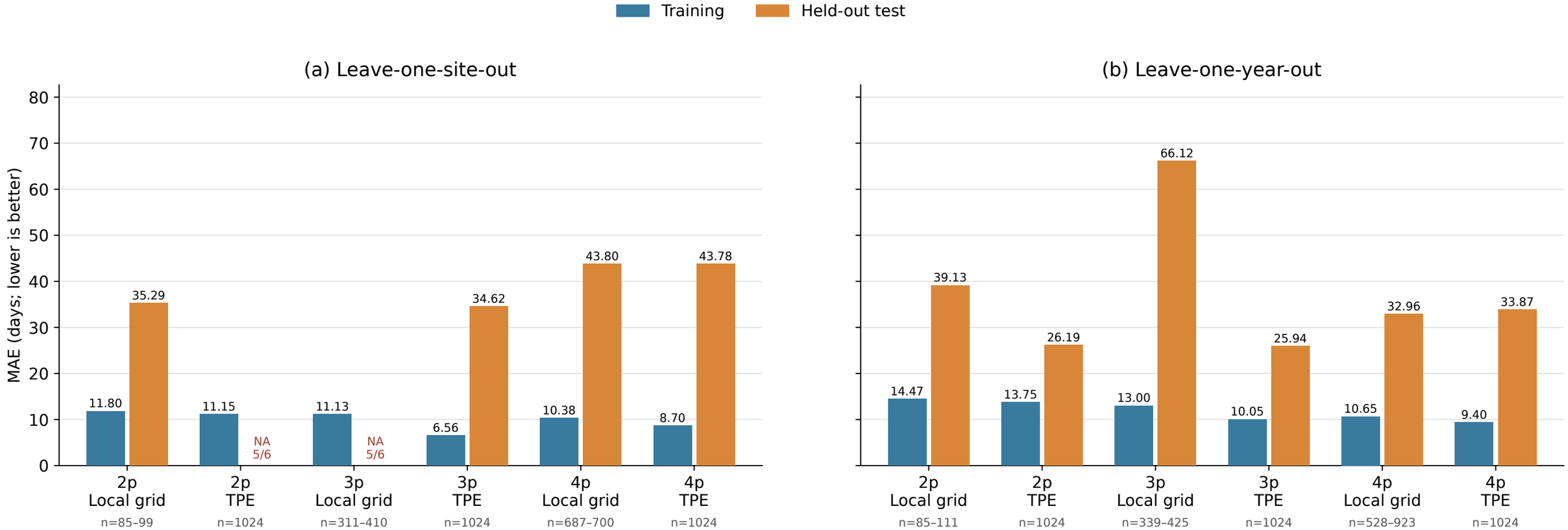

Final selections; seed 20260914. Six site-years per method; n = trials per fold (unequal budgets).
Training: fold MAEs weighted by training-set size; overlapping training sets are not independent validation.
Held-out test: six site-years, equally weighted; a complete MAE requires all six predictions.
2p: VPD/I; 3p: VPD/I/wind (RH=80, MP=3); 4p: VPD/I/RH/MP. 3p and 4p are not nested.
site/2p_tpe: conditional MAE = 27.37 days for 5/6 predicted cases only (not plotted).
site/3p_grid: conditional MAE = 35.58 days for 5/6 predicted cases only (not plotted).